Thank you. What a complete man you are. It’s been an honour indeed.

Where would I be without my friends? To all of you, shot for all the support and let’s carry on with the good times, okay?

Now to my family – the people I’ve hardly seen because of my travels during these years. I know it hasn’t always been easy, but without your encouragement and support I would never have made it through all the rough times I’ve experienced. I love you all. Daddy, Mommy, Cindy, Rashard, Clinton and family, we will make up for lost time once my cricketing days finally come to an end. For now, let’s just enjoy the next couple of years together. Daddy, I think all your hard work and effort in my younger years eventually paid off to get me where I am today. I’m proud to say I’m your son. I love you immensely.

Rashard my boy, I’ve watched you grow and mature into a fine young man, and I can’t believe you are turning fourteen in a couple of months’ time. Exciting, exciting! Dad’s extremely proud of all your achievements in the classroom and on the sports field. If you continue to enjoy your sport and maintain your dedication, hard work, and of course be a good boy, you’re going to go very far indeed. You have the world at your feet, and I’ll help you achieve whatever it is your heart desires, okay? Never forget how much I love you and what I always tell you: ‘You’re the man!’

Liesl, you’ve been a wonderful mother and you can be proud of raising such a beautiful and loveable boy. He really is a special young man. Thank you.

To all my fans and everyone who has enjoyed the style of cricket I’ve played over the years (and, yes, there is more to come), thank you for your support through it all, good and bad! For me personally, it’s all about you guys and will always be that way. Big up to all of you.

So, with all this said and done, I hope you enjoy reading this book as much as Steve and I have enjoyed producing it! Steve, you’re a champion; it’s been a pleasure!

I’ve been asked by a few people: What made you want to do the book? My answer was simply, ‘To celebrate life.’

Enjoy.

Hersch

HERSCHELLE GIBBS